

Data Retention and Disposal Policy

HD Laser Studio INC · 759 Turquoise St, San Diego, CA 92109 · Version 1.0 · Effective September 24, 2026 · Review annually and after any material change · Companion to the Information Security Policy

1. Purpose and scope

This policy defines how long HD Laser Studio keeps each kind of information, why, and how it is deleted when that period ends. It covers customer, employee and company financial data in every system the company uses, including bank and card data retrieved through Plaid. It applies to the owner and to every employee and contractor.

2. Principles

1. We keep data only as long as there is a business, tax or legal reason to keep it.
 2. Where the law sets a minimum (tax records, telemarketing consent), that minimum is the retention period. Nothing is kept "just in case."
 3. Financial data retrieved from bank accounts is used only for the company's own accounting. It is never sold, shared or used for marketing.
 4. Deletion means the record is removed from the live system and from any export or copy the company controls. Provider backups age out on the provider's schedule.
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3. Retention schedule

DATA	WHERE IT LIVES	KEPT FOR	REASON
Quote requests and inquiries that never become an order	Cloudflare database, company email	2 years from last contact	Follow-up and marketing consent record
Orders, invoices, proofs and customer contact details	Cloudflare database, Square, company email	7 years from the last order	Tax and business records
Payment records	Square (card numbers are never stored by HD Laser)	7 years	Tax and chargeback defense
Text-message consent and opt-out records	Cloudflare database	While opted in, then 4 years after opt-out	TCPA record-keeping
Bank and card transactions and balances (via Plaid)	Cloudflare database	7 years	Bookkeeping and tax

Plaid access tokens	Cloudflare database	Until the account is disconnected, then deleted immediately	Needed only while the connection is active
CSV exports of financial or order data	Company devices only	Until the task is done, at most 90 days	Working copies
Employee records: shifts, checklists, jobs, pay estimates	Cloudflare database	4 years after employment ends	California wage and hour rules
Employee logins and PINs	Cloudflare database	Deactivated the day employment ends; deleted after 4 years	Access control; audit trail
Security incident records	Owner's records	3 years	Information Security Policy §9
System and access logs	Cloudflare	Provider default, up to 30 days	Troubleshooting and security review
Website source code	GitHub	Indefinitely (contains no personal or financial data)	Business asset

4. Disposal methods

1. **Database records** are deleted with a permanent delete, not marked hidden. The owner runs the retention review described in section 6 and deletes records past their period.
2. **Bank connections** are removed from the owner dashboard, which revokes access at Plaid and deletes the token from the database. The owner may also remove access through Plaid Portal (my.plaid.com).
3. **Files on company devices** (exports, artwork, scans) are deleted and the trash emptied. Devices are wiped before they are sold, recycled or handed to someone else.
4. **Paper** (printed reports, order sheets with customer details) is shredded.
5. **Email** containing customer or financial data is deleted from the mailbox and its trash when the related record is deleted.
6. **Hosted providers** (Square, Plaid, Twilio, Resend, Google) delete data under their own published schedules once we delete or disconnect it on our side.

5. Requests from individuals

1. Anyone may ask what personal information we hold about them, ask for a correction, or ask for deletion, by emailing contact@hdlaser.net or calling (858) 373-9866.

2. The owner confirms the request, verifies the requester's identity against the details on file, and completes it within 30 days (45 days at most, as California law allows), then replies to confirm.
3. Records we are legally required to keep (for example, tax records of a completed order) are kept for the remainder of their period and the requester is told which records those are and why.
4. Bank account holders may disconnect their accounts at any time from the dashboard or through Plaid Portal.

6. Enforcement and review

1. The owner, Hugh Demiral, is responsible for this policy.
2. Twice a year, in January and July, the owner reviews the retention schedule against the data actually held and deletes anything past its period. The review and what was deleted are noted in the owner's records.
3. This policy is reviewed at least once a year and whenever a system, vendor, law or the way data is used changes. Changes are dated and the version number is increased.
4. Employees follow this policy as part of the Information Security Policy they acknowledge on their first day.

Adopted by: _____ Hugh Demiral, Owner Date: _____